FARMLIFE

KCFB
KINGS COUNTY FARM BUREAU

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INSIDE

PROPOSED WATER DISTRICT **PG. 7**

POULTRY & DAIRY CATTLE BAN **PG. 9**

SPRAYDAYS CA **PG. 11**

SGMA remains a top concern for Tulare Lake Subbasin Growers

Groundwater Sustainability Agencies (GSA) in the Tulare Lake Subbasin (TLSB) remain focused on complying with SGMA as KCFB's lawsuit against the State Water Resources Control Board (SWRCB) works to address concerns regarding SGMA oversight by state regulators. Local GSAs are committed to creating groundwater management plans (GSP) that comply with the law while protecting landowners in the subbasin.

The Mid-Kings River GSA (MKRGSA) has appointed its Stakeholder Advisory Committee, which the board of directors has tasked to review the GSA's current GSP and suggest updates to the plan. The committee met for the first time on Monday, January 13, 2025. At that meeting, Garrett Gilcrease and Kevin Ruble were appointed Chair and Vice Chair of the committee. The group also agreed to meet every Monday afternoon beginning January 27th at 2:00 pm. The committee will review current data and GSP components one at a time and determine if updates or changes should be recommended to the board of directors. Anyone who farms or owns land in the MKRGSA is encouraged to participate in these meetings. This is the best opportunity to provide input and help shape the GSP for the area.

At the South Fork Kings GSA (GSA), the Grower Advisory Committee meets monthly on the first Thursday at 9:00 a.m. These meetings are open to the public, and landowners are encouraged to attend and participate. Just like in the MKRGSA, these meetings are the best opportunity for you to contribute to the

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KCFB welcomes four new Board of Directors

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On January 21, KCFB appointed four new directors to serve on the board. Zach Bickner, Eddie Esajian, Kevin Ruble, and Daniel Soares expressed interest in joining the board beginning in the Summer of 2024. They underwent an application and review process before their appointments. KCFB's board of directors consists of 10 district seats, with districts matching those of the County Board of Supervisors and 11 at-large seats. After these appointments, KCFB's board filled 20 of its 21 positions with active directors representing the diversity of Kings County agriculture. The board strives for well-rounded representation from geographic regions and industry sectors when considering who is a good fit to serve the organization. When considering both factors for the newly seated directors, it was easy for the board to appoint each to serve.

Zach Bickner is the ranch manager for his family's Kings County farming operation. The Bickner ranch consists of tree nuts, corn, cotton, wheat, and alfalfa. As a fourth-generation grower, Zach says he joined the KCFB board to "advocate for future generations." He is excited about the advocacy work KCFB is doing and wants to "assist in the further momentum." As a result, he wants to see "a better outlook on agriculture from the community." Zach stated, "the Kings County community relies on us, not only for food but for jobs. Agriculture encompasses everything that our community relies on. A positive outcome for agriculture is a positive outcome for the whole community." He is excited to learn about new policies and issues and how to be a part of change. Zach is "here to help the bold steps KCFB is making by going the extra mile to fight for Kings County growers."

BOD continued on page 6

KCFB
KINGS COUNTY FARM BUREAU

Purpose
Protect, preserve and enhance agriculture in Kings County

Vision
Ensure that every farmer has the right to farm and protect their heritage

Values
Our Members | Proactive Representative
Reliable | Trusted Resource

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President: Shane Bickner
Vice President: Garrett Gilcrease
Secretary/Treasurer: Chad Souza

Directors
Zach Bickner, John Ellis, Eddie Esajian, Dino Giacomazzi, Keith Grabow, Pete Hanse, Monty Hoggard, David Kahn, Julie Martella, Brian Medeiros, Michael Miya, Brian Potter, Kevin Robertson, Kevin Ruble, Daniel Soares, Helen Sullivan, Frank Zonneveld

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We are in this together

By Dusty Ference, Executive Director

Dusty Ference

At KCFB, our leadership works tirelessly every day to bring real value to our members and the agriculture community in Kings County and beyond. For two full days this January, several of our dedicated directors spent long hours calling both members and non-members from the KCFB office to make sure everyone knew about our lawsuit against the State Water Resources Control Board. To our surprise, many people—farmers, ranchers, and community members alike—were unaware of this critical fight.

While our regular readers of Farm Life may be well informed, it was eye-opening to realize just how many of your friends, neighbors, and colleagues don't know about this critical issue. This highlights a more significant challenge we face in 2025: getting the word out. Even though we have a printed newspaper, an electronic newsletter, active social media channels, and a podcast, it's clear that there are still communication gaps.

That's where you come in.

Word of mouth is still the most powerful tool we have to spread important messages. As a dues-paying member of the Kings County Farm Bureau, you already believe in our work. Now, you can help amplify that message.

Imagine if every one of you told just five people about KCFB's lawsuit and our fight to make sure California's water regulations are fair and just. It's as simple as that. You don't need to ask them to donate—just make sure they understand what KCFB is fighting for and ask them to spread the word.

Once people know what we're doing for the agriculture community, they'll be motivated to support us in whatever way they can—whether that's financially, through further spreading the word, or by encouraging others to learn more.

KCFB is a grassroots organization that thrives when our members are engaged and passionate about the cause. With your help, we can make a real impact and ensure that every farmer and rancher in California knows we're working tirelessly on their behalf.

Together, we improve farming conditions under SGMA.

KCFB Executive Director Dusty Ference and newly elected Kings County District 5 Board of Supervisor Robert Thayer after recording Episode 5 of the Farm Life Podcast.

SGMA continued from page 1

creation of the GSP. During the January 9, 2025, meeting, the committee discussed native yield and groundwater pumping allocations. While SFKGSA's board of directors determines these amounts, the Grower Advisory Committee is responsible for reviewing data and suggesting figures based on the information presented.

The status of KCFB's lawsuit has not changed since the last issue of Farm Life. The SWRCB appealed the preliminary injunction (PI) issued by the judge in September of 2024. The appeals court has not yet ruled on the appeal. Until otherwise reported, the PI remains in effect, and landowners are not required to provide any information to the SWRCB. Unfortunately, until the appeals court makes a ruling, there is nothing KCFB can do concerning the lawsuit. Even scheduling a trial is on hold until a ruling is made. KCFB will update its members as soon as new information is available.

The excitement of SGMA in 2024 has subsided for now, but do not allow yourself to think everything is being handled. Every groundwater user in the TLSB must remain diligent and focused on the work being done in their GSA. These plans will impact everyone, and now is the time to contribute. Investing the time and energy now will influence how you farm tomorrow.

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Content for this month's "Ag News in Brief," provided by the California Farm Bureau Federation

CA Legislature acts to assist those devastated by fires

The California Assembly and Senate held Special Sessions to move quickly on budget-related legislation in support of communities devastated by the Palisades and Eaton fires in Los Angeles. The bills provide $1 billion to augment state emergency response funding for emergency response, cleanup and recovery of areas affected by the fires, provide funding to the Division of the State Architect and other state agencies to expedite technical assistance to local educational agencies regarding efforts to rebuild and repair schools and accelerate access to $1.5 billion in funding for greater preparedness against the growing threats of firestorms and windstorms and other natural disasters. Minority Leader Gallagher offered an amendment to increase the Governor's Proposed 2025 budget by $1 billion, specifically for wildfire fuels mitigation statewide efforts which currently includes a $200 million increase. The amendment was tabled, but the measures still passed from each chamber with bipartisan support.

Congress passes Laken Riley Act

Congress moved swiftly last month to pass the final version of the Laken Riley Act (H.R. 29/S. 5) in a series of bipartisan votes in both chambers. The immigration bill gives the Department of Homeland Security broader discretion to detain undocumented immigrants suspected of certain criminal offenses such as theft and burglary. The bill originated last year following the widely reported death of Laken Riley, a 22-year-old nursing student who was murdered by an illegal immigrant who had previously been detained and released by U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement.

While not directly ag-related, the legislation represents a legislative victory for President Trump, who campaigned heavily on border security and immigration. President Trump signed this piece of legislation into Law Wednesday, January 29th, 2025.

California abandons diesel truck ban and 3 other clean-air rules before Trump is sworn in [CalMatters]

California has decided to abandon its groundbreaking regulations phasing out diesel trucks and requiring cleaner locomotives because the incoming Trump administration is unlikely to allow the state to implement them... California's Advanced Clean Fleet rule, which phases out diesel trucks, was one of the most far-reaching and controversial rules that California has enacted in recent years to reduce air pollution and greenhouse gases. It would have ended the sale of new fossil-fuel trucks in 2036 and required large trucking companies to convert their medium and heavy-duty fleets to electric or hydrogen models by 2042.
https://calmatters.org/environment/2025/01/trump-california-withdraws-diesel-clean-air-rules

Trump Ready to Bypass Congress on Border and Tariffs [The Wall Street Journal]

Days before his inauguration, President-elect Donald Trump made clear in a two-hour private meeting with Senate Republicans that he wouldn't wait on them to start implementing his biggest policy priorities: overhauling the immigration system and dramatically reshaping the country's relationship with its economic allies and adversaries. With the experience of governing and a better knowledge of the levers of power, Trump has drafted expansive plans for tariffs and border restrictions, the centerpieces of his 2024 campaign. He has already prepared roughly 100 executive orders, Trump told lawmakers in the meeting, and said he would press the limits of his presidential authority at times to go it alone on those issues, according to people who attended.
https://www.wsj.com/politics/policy/trump-ready-to-bypass-congress-on-border-and-tariffs-a0c24feb?mod=hp_lead_pos7

Kern groundwater agency bans pumping along sinking California Aqueduct [SJV Water]

A groundwater agency on the western fringes of Kern County has taken the unprecedented step of banning all pumping from wells along the California Aqueduct for a 30-mile stretch. The move is mainly designed to protect the vital artery that moves hundreds of millions of gallons of water a day from northern to southern California and is threatened by sinking land that could crimp its ability to function. The ban is also intended to prove whether groundwater pumping is the true culprit.
https://sjvwater.org/kern-groundwater-agency-bans-pumping-along-sinking-california-aqueduct/

On January 7, after an over two year-long public process, the California State Board of Food and Agriculture unanimously approved a definition for 'Regenerative Agriculture' for use by State of California policies and programs. CDFA set out to define the term as the concept of regenerative agriculture has been increasingly referenced in legislation and has fostered a funding focus in government programs. Throughout the process, Farm Bureau staff provided several comments and recommendations to the State Board to ensure the effort best served the entire agricultural community and Farm Bureau members in this state and that the definition not include specific terms and references in the event of a future legislative interest in codifying the definition. Ultimately, the adopted definition centers around the concept that regenerative agriculture is an integrated approach to farming and ranching rooted in principles of soil health, biodiversity and ecosystem resiliency, leading to improved target outcomes. The definition also reflects that this practice is not an endpoint but rather a continuous implementation of practices that over time minimize inputs and environmental impacts. The finalized definition will be available on the State Board of Food and Agriculture's website in the coming weeks.

The Kings County Farm Bureau distributes Ag News in Brief to its members only for information. Some story links may require website registration. Opinions expressed in stories, commentaries, or editorials included in Ag News in Brief do not necessarily represent the views of the Kings County Farm Bureau.

Membership Outreach Manager Report

By Breanna Larman

Breanna Larman

Who always has a Date on Valentines Day?
A calendar.

Farm Day Reminder

Just a friendly reminder that the Kings County Office of Education (KCOE) has taken over the Farm Day program in its entirety. With advocacy work at the for front of our organization it was a necessary and beneficial hand off to make sure that the Farm Day continues to serve and educate the youth of Kings County about agriculture. We know that the Office of Education will be good stewards of the program and thankful for their hard work and dedication to Farm Day. Farm Day 2025 will be held Thursday, March 20th at the Kings County Fairgrounds. If you have questions about this year's event, please contact the KCOE office in Lemoore at 559-589-7071.

Farm Life Podcast: Episode 5

On January 13th KCFB Executive Director Dusty Ference sat down with newly elected District 5 Kings County Board of Supervisor Robert Thayer to discuss his new position on Episode 5 the Farm Life Podcast. With a rich background in public service through the Kings County Sheriff's Office Thayer is passionate about making a difference in the community and excited to get started. Episode 5 was released on Wednesday, January 15th. Search the "Farm Life Podcast" Apple Podcast, Spotify and YouTube to listen/watch the full interview.

Upcoming Events

Mark your calendars for the 2025 Membership Appreciation Night at the Visalia Rawhide baseball stadium Thursday, May 8th at 6:30pm. As a thank you to our members, Friends of Farm Bureau, and SGMA Defense Fund donors this is a FREE event for you and your family. Call or stop by the KCFB office to claim your FREE tickets in the grandstand or pasture sections.

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200 E. Cartmill Avenue, Tulare, CA 93274

Save the Date
Dairy Risk Management Meeting
with Marin Bozic
Feb. 26, 2025 - 4 p.m.
The Vintage Press
216 N Willis St, Visalia, CA
Feb. 27, 2025 - 10 a.m.
Luigi's Restaurant -
725 E 19th St, Bakersfield, CA
Invitation to follow
Ready to register now?
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200 E. Cartmill Avenue, Tulare, CA 93274

Save the Date
Livestock Risk
Management Meeting
with Marin Bozic
Feb. 27, 2025 - noon
Luigi's Restaurant
725 E 19th St, Bakersfield, CA
Invitation to follow
Ready to register now?
Scan the QR code to reserve your spot.
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visit our website at www.ekrcd.org

*Pump tests are provided for irrigation wells only

BOD continued from page 1

Eddie Esajian grows "a little bit of everything". He and his family are organic regenerative growers who grow cereal grains, corn, veggies, herbs, pumpkins, and more in their market garden. If you attended our 2024 KCFB annual meeting, all of the beautiful decorative pumpkins came from Eddie's garden! Eddie has also been a Kings County walnut grower for the last 8 years. Eddie says he joined the board because, "It was about time I got involved in a leadership role. I feel like I needed to contribute and help out. I want to be someone that does something." Since the start of KCFB's legal battle with the State Water Resources Control Board Eddie said he has, "a new perspective on his land and livelihood due to the current water issues" he wants to help "put a stop to the threat of the state running us out of agriculture". "Agriculture is very important, critical, paramount, and necessary," Eddie stated when asked about the importance of agriculture was in Kings County. Eddie looks forward to getting involved and being part of the solution.

Kevin Ruble has been a Kings County grower for the last 16 years. He grows pistachios, grapes, pomegranates, and silage. Kevin is excited to work on the KCFB board of directors and is committed to ensuring agriculture succeeds. He is most looking forward to "meshing ideas with others to come up with the best solutions." Kevin says, "times are different; we need positive and focused ideas to get us through regulations." He wants to help "guide the ship in tough times" and "help people better understand agriculture, tightening the relationship between the agriculture industry and the general population." He is eager to "continue the good work, find new outreach efforts and learn more about the KCFB organization as a whole." Through his new role as a board member Kevin would like to engage the non-agriculture community with the issues growers face. "Its important people understand nothing else works if we don't have a good food supply, we have to feed ourselves, agriculture needs to be the base of our pyramid."

Daniel Soares has been a grower in Kings County for 20 years. He is a proud husband and father of 4 boys, whom he hopes will all follow in his footsteps and go into agriculture someday. He says, "The best thing I've ever done is raise those boys." He and his family grow alfalfa, row crops with pistachios as their main commodity. Six months ago, Daniel wasn't on a board of any kind and has now found a seat on four different boards in Kings County. The most recent being the KCFB board of directors. His decision to jump in headfirst was a call to "step up and do what I can." Daniels says he was driven to become part of the KCFB board of directors to "do something, instead of sitting on the sidelines", and to "be a voice for people and really make a difference." With a passion for service, Daniel is excited to help fight for the agriculture industry in Kings County and learn everything he can about the issues that challenge our growers. "Without agriculture there would be very few jobs; our valley relies on agriculture; it keeps the valley going," Daniel said.

KCFB's Board of Directors is excited by the diversity of ideas and passion these newly appointed directors bring to the organization. Adding new ideas and energy to the boardroom will ensure new ideas are shared and considered and that new life is breathed into existing efforts and strategies.

Proposed ag water district could aid groundwater-dependent farmers in northern Tulare County

By Lisa McEwen

A proposed new agricultural water district could brighten what had been shaping up as a grim future for a number of farmers in the northern part of Tulare County's flatlands under the state's groundwater law.

Four private ditch companies are working to form the new district to cover 84,000 acres, 24,000 of which are totally groundwater dependent. Pumping restrictions under the Sustainable Groundwater Management Act (SGMA) are expected to severely limit crop production in such groundwater reliant areas.

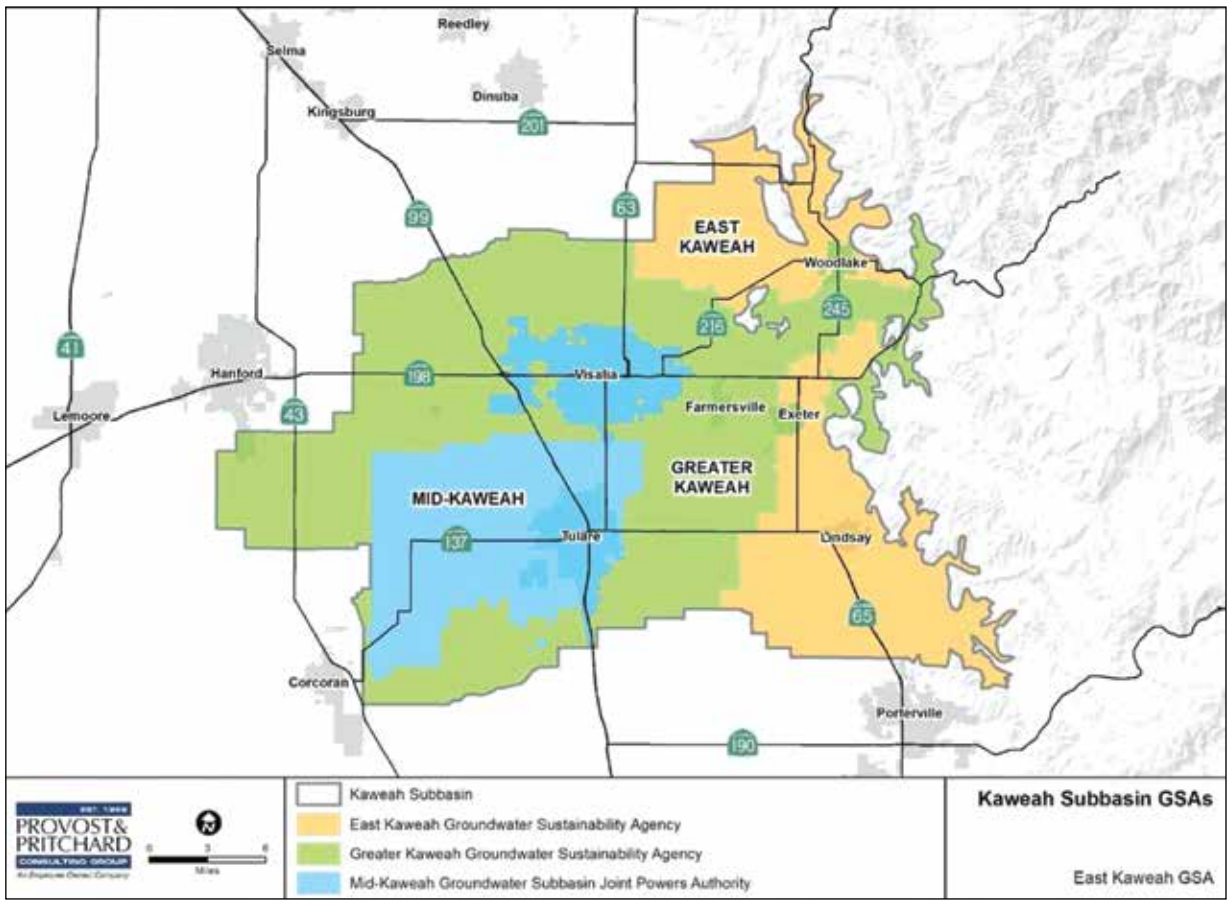
The proposed Consolidated Water District has indicated it will use land assessment fees to buy surface water and build systems to convey surface water throughout the district.

That's significant, said Mark Larsen, General Manager of the Greater Kaweah Groundwater Sustainability Agency (GSA), which covers the area where the new district is proposed.

"Every drop of surface water that is provided for irrigation directly reduces a drop of groundwater pumped," Larsen said.

The proposal was approved by Tulare's Local Agency Formation Commission and the Tulare County Board of Supervisors has approved submitting the proposal to a vote of the landowners. That mail-in ballot election will be on May 6.

How to reduce pumping in groundwater-dependent areas, so-called "white lands," has been a stubborn issue for water managers throughout the state. Land that isn't covered by a water district is white on color-coded district maps, hence the nickname.



The problem with white lands is that growers there have never paid land assessment fees to bring in water, getting all their irrigation water from pumping. But under SGMA, aquifers must be brought into balance by 2040. In white lands, the only option is to curtail pumping.

So, creation of a water district that includes the white lands is a welcome solution for this slice of the Kaweah basin.

"It's not going to be the end-all solution, but it will be of some help," said James Silva of forming a new district. Silva is the general manager of Consolidated People's Ditch Company and 14 other ditch companies.

"Early on, we had some guys who owned ground with no stock and they got together and wanted to see what they could do to gear up for SGMA," Silva added. "We decided we would all be better off if we made a district over the top of everyone."

The only negative, he said, is having to levy fees.

"We can't form a district without an assessment," he said.

He said the four ditch companies forming the water district all have pre-1914 water rights to Kaweah River water. Landowners lucky enough to have stock in the ditch companies own river water like "a pink slip for your car."

The Kaweah subbasin in the northern half of Tulare County's flatlands. Consolidated Ditch Company's office with surrounding recharge basins. Courtesy James Silva

Silva said Consolidated People's was in a position to take the lead because it has the best conveyance system and channel capacity of all the ditch companies. This will allow for future capture of flood flows, especially off the Yokohl Creek, which burst its banks in several areas in the spring of 2023, flooding citrus orchards and filling them with several feet of sediment.

Silva said the Consolidated People's channel can take up to 2,000 cubic feet per second.

"Yokohl dumps in on us, and it could help with some of the flooding if we were able to build basins in the right locations," he said. "We can take uncontrolled flows out of Yokohl and send water all the way out toward the (Tulare Lake) bed."

The proposed boundaries of the new water district are mostly within the Kaweah Delta Water Conservation District and the Greater Kaweah Groundwater Sustainability Agency (GSA).

SJV Water is an independent, nonprofit news site covering water in the San Joaquin Valley, www.sjvwater.org.
Email us at sjvwater@sjvwater.org

SGMA DEFENSE FUND

Join the Fight!

KCFB's legal challenge against the State Water Resources Control Board has already saved growers in the Tulare Lake Subbasin millions of dollars and kept state intervention off your farm. But the fight isn't over yet—and we need your support to finish strong. By contributing, you'll play a crucial role in securing a win for California agriculture, protecting farms, and ensuring the future of farming in California. This is a pivotal moment—your support can make all the difference. **Join us in defending California's agricultural community!**

Contact KCFB by phone at 559-584-3557, via email at kcfb@kcfb.org, or visit the KCFB website for more information.

HOW YOU CAN HELP:

$8 PER ACRE: GROWERS IN THE TULARE SUB-BASIN
$4 PER ACRE: GSA ORGANIZATIONS
$4 PER ACRE: GROWERS OUTSIDE THE TULARE SUB-BASIN

BUSINESS SUPPORT LEVELS: $2,500 • $5,000 • $10,000

Please make checks payable to:

Kings County Farm Bureau
870 Greenfield Ave.,
Hanford, CA 93230

Include SGMA Defense Fund on the memo line

State Veterinarian Bans All California Poultry and Dairy Cattle Exhibitions at Fairs and Shows

Dear Poultry and Dairy Cattle Exhibition Organizers and Managers:

H5N1 Avian Influenza (Bird Flu) has become widespread among dairy cows and domestic poultry (commercial and backyard flocks) in California. In fact, California Governor Gavin Newsom has declared a state of emergency due to these detections. Since August 2024, there have been over 700 dairy herds and 60 poultry flocks affecting over 15 million birds with new dairies and flocks being detected.

Due to the continued spread of H5N1 Bird Flu in California, the State Veterinarian has implemented a ban on all California Poultry and Dairy Cattle Exhibitions at Fairs and Shows immediately until further notice. This action is required to minimize the danger of exposing people and non-infected cows and birds to the disease.

We urge dairy cow and poultry owners to prevent this devastating disease by continuing to practice enhanced biosecurity measures and prevent comingling with wild bird populations, with other poultry/dairy cows, and their owners. They should also avoid moving or sharing equipment that may serve to transfer the virus. Dairy cow and poultry owners with flocks that have experienced any unusual/suspicious illness or deaths should not move their cows, birds, or their milk or poultry products and should call their veterinarian or our CDFA Sick Bird Hotline at 866-922-BIRD (2473).

Avian influenza is a highly contagious and often fatal disease in birds. The viral spread is promoted by wild birds, especially in wild waterfowl such as ducks and geese, but many other wild bird species can also be a source of spread. The disease spreads through movement of infected or exposed birds, direct or indirect contact with infected wild and domestic birds or contact with virus on fomites (surfaces) such as hands, shoes, clothing, or feet and fur of rodents and other animals. In addition, dairy cows have also been affected by the disease this year, so increased precautions should be taken especially for farms that have both cows and poultry or are in the vicinity of a dairy cow farm.

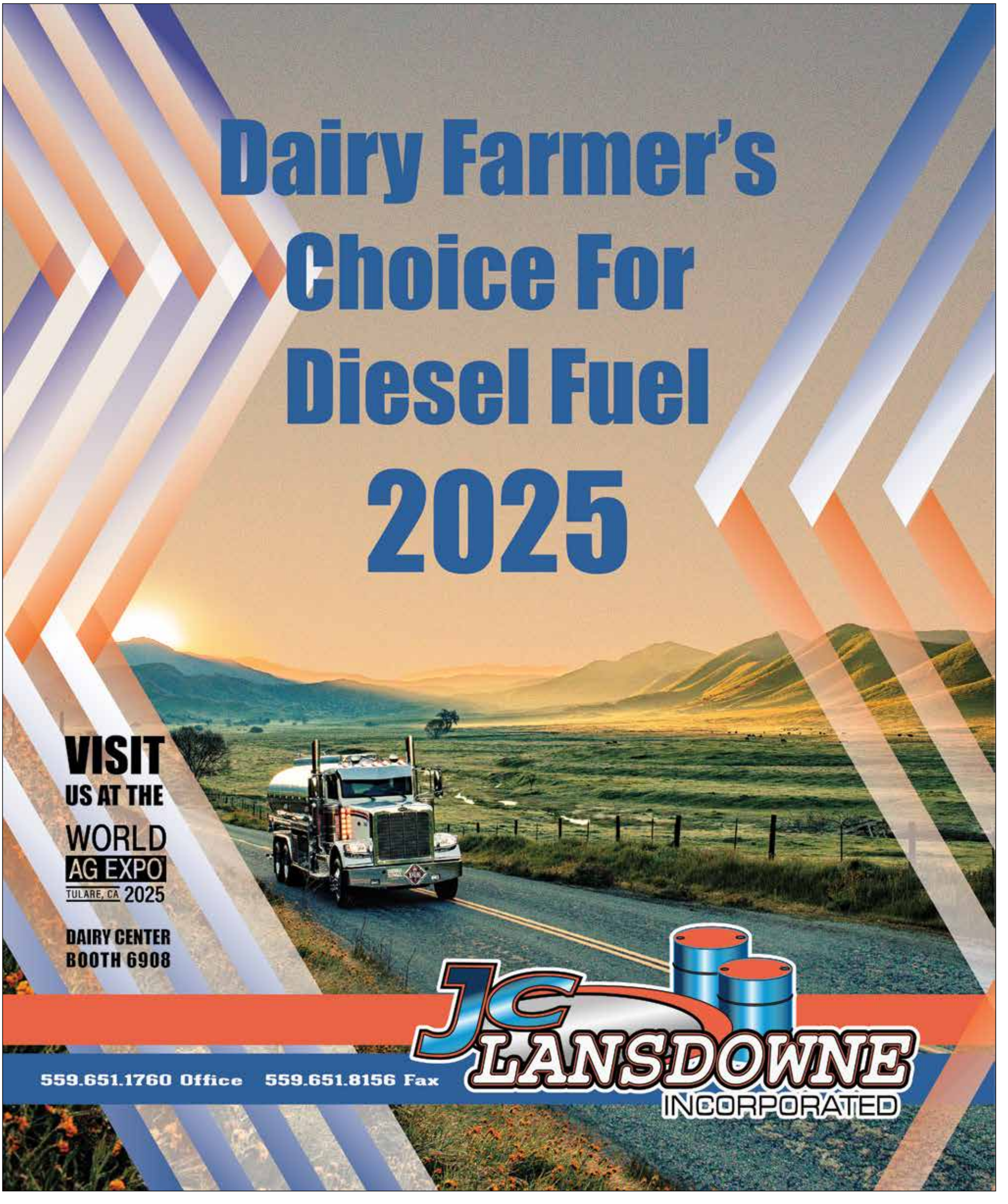
Clinical signs of H5N1 bird flu in cows include decrease in feed consumption with a simultaneous decrease in rumination and rumen motility, respiratory signs (including clear nasal discharge), acute drop in milk production (severely affected cattle may have thicker, concentrated, colostrum-like milk or produce no milk at all), abnormal tacky or loose feces, lethargy, dehydration, and fever. For more information, please visit our CDFA H5N1 Bird Flu Virus in Livestock webpage.

Clinical signs of H5N1 bird flu (highly pathogenic) in poultry include sudden death, trouble breathing, clear runny discharge (from nose, mouth, and eyes), lethargy, decreased food and water intake, swelling (eyes, head, wattles, or combs), discolored or bruised comb, wattles, or legs, stumbling/falling or twisted neck. For more information, please visit our CDFA HPAI H5N1 in Poultry webpage.

The cooperation of cow and bird owners is critical in controlling this disease; when exposed cows and birds are not moved and comingled, disease spread can be prevented. We will continue to assess the threat over the next few months and rescind this ban if the situation changes. If you have any questions, please do not hesitate to contact me directly. Thank you for your cooperation.

For up-to-date information about the HPAI 2022-24 outbreak, you can check the USDA APHIS Detections of Highly Pathogenic Avian Influenza webpage.

Sincerely,
Annette Jones,
D.V.M.
Dr. Annette Jones
State Veterinarian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Ag Commissioner's Compliance Report

Jimmy Hook, Agricultural Commissioner/Sealer

SprayDays California - Statewide Notification of Agricultural Use of Restricted Materials

Contributed by Janet Eckles

In the August 2024 issue we talked about this very subject. We are bringing it back because it has now become official and regulations are expected to be live as of February 24, 2025. This regulatory action will affect the requirements for the Restricted Materials Notice of Intents (NOIs). This article will inform you of the new requirements, the changes from how they were previously done, and the way the Kings County Agricultural Commissioner's office is going to handle these changes.

One of the biggest changes occurring with SprayDays is the requirement of electronic submission of all NOIs. In the past NOIs were accepted in paper form, by telephone, fax, and by email. With this new regulatory action, the only accepted submission is electronically through CalAgPermits or a program that can electronically submit them into CalAgPermits. The Kings County

Agricultural Commissioner may allow a non-electronic submittal upon the finding of undue hardship. An undue hardship may be a situation in which compliance is not possible without significant difficulty or expense. Anyone who feels this applies to them are encouraged to contact our office.

The start or commencement time of the application along with the county number, which in Kings County it is 16, are now required to be on the NOI. The start date was previously required; however, the anticipated start time was not. Submission time for all soil fumigant NOIs will be 48 hours before the commence date/time and 24 hours for all other restricted materials (unless labeling or county permit conditions require a longer time frame). For example, if you are planning an application for a Friday at 9:00 am, the NOI for a soil fumigant must be submitted by 9:00 am on Wednesday, and for other restricted materials it would be Thursday by 9:00 am. Waivers or exemptions will still be granted but changes in regulations mean there will be stricter requirements for approval.

The Kings County Agricultural Commissioner's office has been working with those who submit NOIs to get them in line with the new requirements so this change will not be so disruptive to the process. If you are an applicator that usually submits NOIs by other means than electronically, our office can get you a log in to CalAgPermits and guide you through the process of submitting an NOI this way. There are other electronic systems such as Telus and Tiger Jill that will also transmit the NOI into CalAgPermits.

SprayDays will send an email to those who sign up with information about upcoming applications. It will tell them the general location of the intended application within one square mile but does not pinpoint the site. It will also tell them the intended date and time of the application, product name, active ingredient, and application method.

NOIs are good for four days from the anticipated start date, if you go past the four days and have not started the application you are required to resubmit a new NOI for that application. Once you have started the application on the NOI you have fulfilled the requirement of the regulation.

If you have any questions or would like to set up access to CalAgPermits to submit your NOIs, please contact the Kings County Agricultural Commissioner's Office at 559-852-2830.

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If you have questions about your current sponsorship, would like to renew or join as a Friend of Farm Bureau, please contact Breanna at the KCFB office. 559-584-3557 or at blarman@kcfb.org

Kings County Rural Crime Report

To the Kings County Farm Bureau Members:

January: Throughout the month of January, the Kings County Rural Crimes Task Force has been busy with copper, quad and UTV theft all over the county. Lately, there has continued to be a steady rise in copper thefts. These particular thefts are difficult to investigate due to them often being reported days or weeks after the theft has ben committed, along with other factors such as weather, time of night, etc. However, we as a unit are constantly trying to stay ahead of the thieves by putting out trail cameras and conducting constant patrols. We have had great success in identifying several suspects and have made numerous arrests regarding copper and UTV thefts.

More often than not, these thefts are committed by career criminals that are typically part of a crew that do nothing but steal ag equipment and sell it to subsidize their incomes and fuel their drug addictions. It is imperative that if anyone knows of or hears of any buying or selling obviously stolen equipment, to call the Sheriff's Office. We continue to investigate all Ag related thefts and encourage members to call and report all Ag related crimes. If we do not receive calls from our members and community we may not be aware of certain crimes occurring in your area.

Detective Fausnett **(559) 639-8704**
Detective Thomas **(559) 530-1701**
Detective Coghlan **(559) 362-3078**
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